

Page 1 - Diabetes Mellitus Overview

Diabetes mellitus is a chronic metabolic disorder characterized by hyperglycemia resulting from defects in insulin secretion, insulin action, or both. Type 1 diabetes is caused by autoimmune destruction of pancreatic beta cells. Type 2 diabetes is associated with insulin resistance and relative insulin deficiency.

Diagnostic criteria (fasting plasma glucose):

- Normal: less than 100 mg/dL
- Prediabetes: 100-125 mg/dL
- Diabetes: 126 mg/dL or higher on two separate tests

First-line treatment for type 2 diabetes includes lifestyle modification and metformin unless contraindicated.